

Security desk

Revise 360 lesson plan — 60 minutes

Unit	OCR J277 2.3 Producing robust programs — Paper 2, Computational thinking, algorithms and programming
Lesson	Security desk (lesson 1 of the unit)
Lesson ID	rp-l01
Experience ID	rp-l01
Plan ID	PLAN-RP-L01
Content version	f19e073a1cc6
Website	https://revise360.co.uk/experience.html?id=rp-l01

Big question, outcomes and success criteria

Big question — How can a programmer make sure a program copes with anything a user types?

Prerequisites

None within this unit: it is the first lesson. Treat the starter as a baseline check rather than retrieval of something you have taught.

Assessable outcomes

1. **rp-l01-o1** — know what is meant by defensive design when writing programs
2. **rp-l01-o2** — understand why input validation is necessary
3. **rp-l01-o3** — know a range of validation techniques used to write robust programs

Vocabulary, resources and preparation

Key vocabulary — Defensive design, Anticipating misuse

Resources

SLIDES	presentations/RP_L01_SecurityDesk_Lesson.pptx
WORKSHEET	worksheets/RP_L01_SecurityDesk_Worksheet.docx
ONLINE EXPERIENCE	experience.html?id=rp-l01

Before the lesson

1. Sign in on the **teacher dashboard** (teacher.html) and open **Class logins**. Enter the class or group and the usernames, one per line, then print the login cards. A pupil cannot sign in without one, so do this before the lesson rather than in it.
2. Print the worksheet, one per pupil.
3. Open the slides and the experience once yourself, on the machine you will be teaching from, so the 360 image is already cached.
4. Check headsets or devices are charged and on the school network.

How pupils get in

1. Go to `topics.html` on `revise360.co.uk`.
2. Sign in with the **username and PIN from the login card**. The class is already set against the card.

3. Choose the topic, then this lesson's card.

Worth knowing before you promise anything. In this build APP_CONFIG.backendUrl is empty, so logins, login cards and progress are stored on the device the pupil used. The teacher dashboard says so too. A pupil who moves to a different machine starts again, so keep a class on the same devices within a unit, and treat the paper worksheet as the record that travels.

Teaching sequence

Sixty minutes including transitions. The online block is the one to move if your lesson is shorter: see the adaptation at the end.

MIN	PHASE	TEACHER	PUPILS	EVIDENCE TO CHECK
0-5	Retrieve	Starter on the board or the worksheet, from the last lesson and this lesson's prerequisites.	Answer the starter on the worksheet.	The starter box on RP_L01_SecurityDesk_Worksheet.docx is filled in.
5-8	Review the starter	Take answers; correct the one most got wrong.	Correct their own starter.	A correction written, not just a tick.
8-18	Explain and model	The new idea in two or three steps, with the example worked in front of the class.	Listen and answer questions about the example.	They can say why, not only what.
18-21	Set up and settle	Sign-in, launch, and what to write before anyone taps an answer.	Sign in, open the lesson, find Defensive design.	Everyone is in and on station 1.
21-43	Online: work the stations in order	Pupils read each wall, write the key fact and the challenge, then answer at the badge.	Read each wall, write the key fact and the challenge, then answer at the badge.	The worksheet has writing on it for each of the 6 stations before the badge is tapped.
43-48	Check understanding	The hinge question, hands down.	Answer the hinge question, hands down.	The split across the options.
48-56	Apply	Exam practice on the worksheet, in silence.	Exam practice, in silence.	worksheet, Exam practice a) to c)
56-60	Exit and set up the next lesson	The exit question and the retrieval link to next lesson.	Write the exit answer.	One sentence that answers the big question.

The explanation and the worked example

This is what the walls of the experience say, station by station. Teach the first two or three from the front before anyone puts a headset on; the rest the pupils read for themselves.

1. Defensive design

- Designing a program so it can't be broken by mistakes or deliberate misuse.
- Includes input validation, authentication, anticipating misuse and maintainable code.
- Assume users will do something unexpected.

Challenge on this wall: List three things that could go wrong if a program trusted every input.

2. Type check

- Checks the data is the correct data type, such as a whole number rather than text.
- Stops a program crashing when it tries to do maths with text.

Challenge on this wall: Which inputs on a sign-up form need a type check?

3. Range check

- Checks data falls within acceptable limits, such as 1 to 3.
- Anything outside the range is rejected.

Challenge on this wall: Suggest a sensible range check for a month and for a percentage score.

4. Presence check

- Checks that some data has been entered.
- Stops required fields, like a username, being left blank.

Challenge on this wall: Which fields on a sign-up form must have a presence check?

5. Format and length checks

- A format check makes sure data matches a pattern, such as DD/MM/YYYY or a postcode.
- A length check makes sure data has the right number of characters, such as 11 digits for a mobile number.

Challenge on this wall: Describe a format check and a length check for a UK postcode.

6. Whitelists and blacklists

- A whitelist stores the only inputs a program should accept, e.g. A, B and C.
- A blacklist stores inputs a program should reject, e.g. illegal characters in file names.
- A string can be cast to a number after it has been checked.

Challenge on this wall: Would you use a whitelist or a blacklist for a menu with options A, B and C? Why?

Retrieval and the check for understanding

Starter — A club membership form asks for a name, a date of birth and a mobile number. For each field, write down one check the program should make before it accepts the data.

Answer space: 3 lines on the worksheet.

The answer is in the teacher answers for this unit, not on this plan: a plan left on a desk should not give it away.

Hinge question

Use this one, hands down, before anyone moves on to independent work. It is a real activity from the experience (rp-101-s4-c1), so the wording a pupil sees matches the wording you say.

What does a presence check do?

Correct: Checks that something has been entered

What a pupil might choose instead

- Checks the data type
- Checks the length
- Checks the user is present in the room

Count the hands on each. If more than a few of the class are on one wrong option, that option is the misconception to teach against before anyone goes on: go back to the station this question sits on and work through its example again, aloud, before the independent work.

The course's own response to a wrong answer here: It rejects empty input.

One response, not four. one response covers every wrong option; it does not say what to revisit for each one, so decide your own reteach for each option before the lesson - the list above is the start of it.

Guided to independent practice

STAGE	ACTIVITIES	WHAT IT IS
Guided	13	Support is in the activity: an example to run, an output to predict, one thing to change, a gap to fill.
Independent	0	The pupil writes or fixes it with the brief and nothing else.

Challenge	0	The hardest activity on each station. It is not optional and it is not extra: it is the last step of the station.
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Every activity in this lesson is guided: a pupil chooses between options and never produces anything of their own. Plan the independent work yourself - the exam practice on the worksheet is the obvious place - and do not read a full score here as evidence that a pupil can do it unaided.

Scaffolds already in the product, and how they fade

- **Hint** is a ladder, not a door: the first rung names the idea, the next shows the shape of the code, the next how it starts, the last animates the technique on different data. A pupil asks for each rung. None of them is the answer.
- **Run** is free and unmarked; **Check my answer** marks. A pupil may run as often as they like, which is what makes trial and error safe.
- **I need help** says to ask you, and says plainly that the question still has to be completed. It does not notify anyone and it does not unlock anything.
- The worked example appears on every early activity and on none of the late ones. That fade is deliberate; it is not a missing example.

Accessibility

- **Read aloud** on every task window reads the task and its brief, with the prescribed values read as values rather than as punctuation.
- Text is 16px or larger throughout, and a question window scrolls rather than shrinking its type.
- Prescribed data is boxed and in a monospace face as well as coloured, so it still reads as code in black and white, in a high-contrast mode, and to a pupil who does not separate green from amber.
- **Lower literacy and EAL:** pre-teach the vocabulary above; let the pupil say the key fact before writing it; accept the key fact in two or three words.
- **SEND:** the sequence is compulsory but the pace is not. A pupil may finish a station next lesson; the progress saves after every answer and reopens at their earliest unfinished question.
- A headset is never required. Every experience works on a laptop or a tablet with a mouse or a finger.

Delivering the online experience

Before anyone enters

- Worksheet out, pen in hand. The rule is write first, then answer at the badge: the first answer is the one that counts.
- Say where the stations are. They are numbered around the room: 1 and 2 to the right, 3 and 4 behind, 5 and 6 to the left, and the final challenge on the floor.
- Say that a badge marked **Not yet** is not a fault. It opens when the station they are on is finished.

The stations, and what to record at each

#	STATION	ACTIVITIES	RECORD ON PAPER
1	Defensive design	2	Defensive design means...
2	Type check	2	A type check makes sure...
3	Range check	2	A range check makes sure...
4	Presence check	2	A presence check makes sure...
5	Format and length checks	2	A format check... A length check...
6	Whitelists and blacklists	2	A whitelist... A blacklist...
final	Final challenge: date checks	1	the answer to the station's challenge

Where to pause

Stop the class after station 2 and take answers to its challenge out loud. That is the point where a pupil who has misread the technique can still be put right cheaply.

Afterwards

Headsets off and down. Ask three pupils for the key fact from a station of your choosing, in their own words and not read off the sheet. Then the exit question.

Assessment, evidence and unfinished work

ID	QUESTION	MARKS	WHERE
rp-101-x1	Describe what input validation is and why programmers use it.	2	worksheet, Exam practice a); deck, Exam practice slide
rp-101-x2	A form asks for a UK mobile number. Describe two validation checks it should make, and say what each one catches.	4	worksheet, Exam practice b); deck, Exam practice slide
rp-101-x3	Explain the difference between a range check and a type check, using an example of each.	4	worksheet, Exam practice c); deck, Exam practice slide

Expected answers

Model answers and marking guidance are teacher-only and are not printed on this plan. They are in the unit's teacher guide pack, and the per-activity marking for this lesson is in `answers/records/rp-101.json`, which is not published with the website.

Common errors

The wrong options the activities offer are the errors this lesson expects. The commonest to watch for:

- **What is defensive design?** — Adding a firewall; Writing the program as fast as possible
- **What is input validation?** — Checking the user's identity; Encrypting the data
- **Which check would stop 'twelve' being entered as an age?** — Length check; Presence check
- **What does `isnumeric()` check in the code?** — Whether the input is empty; Whether it's in the right range
- **Which check would reject a month of 13?** — Type check; Presence check

Unfinished work

Record where each pupil stopped, not a tick. They resume at their earliest unfinished question, and a station left half-done is the thing to open next lesson. Do not mark the lesson complete for a pupil who did not finish it: the score screen already shows what was and was not done, and that is the honest record.

Exit, next lesson and homework

Exit check

One of these, written, not a show of hands:

- What defensive design means
- Why input validation is necessary
- The five types of validation check

The confidence columns on the worksheet are a supplement to this, not a substitute: a pupil who rates themselves confident and cannot answer the exit question has told you nothing.

Retrieval link to next lesson

Next is rp-102, Cyber defence HQ. Use this lesson's big question as next lesson's starter, so the first thing they do is retrieve it.

Homework

Finish any station left open, on the website, from the question they stopped at. If the class has no devices at home, set the exam practice on the worksheet instead and mark it next lesson.

Shorter lessons, longer lessons and no internet

A 40 to 45 minute lesson

Keep the starter, the explanation and the model at full length: cutting those is what makes the online work fail. Take the time out of the online block and the apply phase. Pupils stop where they are; their progress saves after every answer and reopens at their earliest unfinished question, so the next lesson starts there.

If the internet or the devices are unavailable

Teach from the slides and the worksheet. The slides carry the same teaching as the station walls, and the worksheet carries the key facts, the challenges and the exam practice. Set the online stations when the devices are back.

There is no offline version of the experience, and this plan does not contain one. Do not hand out a printed walkthrough of the stations as a substitute: the experiences are used on the website.

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